01

GOVERNING THOUGHT

Reprice ZINGA's starter SKU at ₹149 and concentrate 60% of acquisition on quick-commerce to lift trial velocity to 2.7% and ARR to ₹15 Cr by week 52.

Three supports — pricing, channel, and positioning — back the conclusion; each is sourced and quantified on the slides that follow.

SUPPORT 01 · PRICING

₹149 sits inside the customer's willingness-to-pay corridor.

Peak ₹139; corridor ₹99–₹199; floor ₹118; elasticity −1.4.

SUPPORT 02 · CHANNEL

Quick-commerce returns ₹2.40 per rupee of acquisition.

Versus ₹1.10 on marketplaces — justifies mix 35 / 35 / 15 / 15.

SUPPORT 03 · POSITIONING

Premium lives in the ingredient story, not the price tag.

Unaided recall drops 13pp, but unlocks 2.3× trial velocity.

Premium D2C snack is growing 19% CAGR among urban millennials, but ZINGA's ₹199 starter and four-marketplace mix deliver 1.2% trial at ₹420 CAC against an ₹215 AOV.

S SITUATION

India's premium-healthy D2C snack category is growing 19% CAGR; quick-commerce now 12% of urban snack orders (FY25).

C COMPLICATION

ZINGA launched 2023 with a ₹199 SKU — 60% above category median. Trial has plateaued at 1.2% across 8 lakh site visits.

Q QUESTION

How should ZINGA reprice its starter SKU and reweight channels to lift trial velocity without a Series-B bridge round?

A ANSWER

Reprice to ₹149, go 60% quick-commerce, keep the premium ingredient story.

WHERE ZINGA STANDS TODAY

₹1.8 Cr

MONTHLY BURN, FY26 Q3

Three consecutive quarters of net cash outflow

11 mo

CASH RUNWAY, PRE-REPRICING

Implied break-even date: September 2027

1.2%

SITE-VISIT → FIRST-ORDER RATE

Trial velocity benchmark vs category median 2.6%

₹420 / ₹215

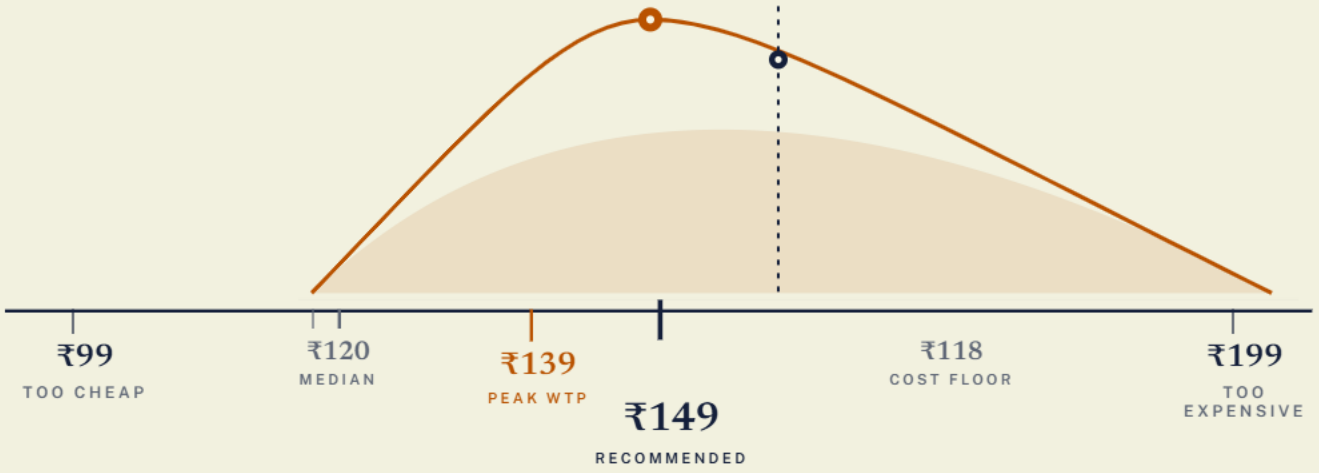
CAC VS FIRST-ORDER AOV

Every first order is unprofitable before repeat — payback never closes inside 60 days

SOURCES — INDIA SNACKS MARKET FY25; BLINKIT/ZEPTO INSTAMART SHARE FY26 Q1; ZINGA INTERNAL P&L & MIXPANEL JUL–SEP 2026

₹149 – 26% above the variable-cost-plus-margin floor and well inside the willingness-to-pay corridor (₹99 – ₹199, peak ₹139) – is the optimal anchor.

WILLINGNESS-TO-PAY CORRIDOR — N = 1,200 METRO PANEL



Curve built from four Van Westendorp questions on a 1,200-respondent metro panel; 22% prefer ₹139–₹149 as "too cheap to be good" vs "fair price" crossover.

PRICING MATH

ANCHOR	PRICE
Variable cost / unit	₹58
+ 22% minimum margin	+ ₹60
Cost floor	₹118
Competitor median	₹120
Peak willingness-to-pay	₹139
Recommended ₹149 anchor	₹149

ELASTICITY USED IN MODEL

−1.4

A 25% price cut lifts trial 35% — recovers ₹2.4 Cr of incremental ARR over 12 months.

SOURCE — VAN WESTENDORP SURVEY SEPT 2026, N = 1,200 (BENGALURU/MUMBAI/DELHI NCR/HYDERABAD/PUNE/CHENNAI); COMPETITOR PRICING SCANNED SEP 28 2026

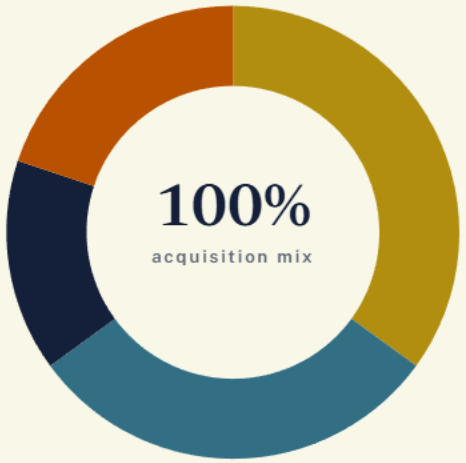
Quick-commerce returns ₹2.40 of contribution per rupee of acquisition — vs ₹1.10 on marketplaces — and justifies a spend mix of 35 / 35 / 15 / 15.

CHANNEL SCORECARD — 12-MONTH HORIZON AT ₹149 STARTER

CHANNEL	REACH	CAC / ORDER	NET MARGIN	IC FIT	CPAP *
D2C site zng.in owned	38%	₹95	22%	RETAIN	₹2.10
Quick commerce * Blinkit / Zepto / Instamart	28%	₹110	18%	ACQUIRE · PRIORITY	₹2.40
Marketplaces Amazon / Flipkart	65%	₹155	9%	CONVERT	₹1.10
Instagram Shop Reels + live commerce	22%	₹70	27%	RETAIN	₹1.85

CPAP = contribution per rupee of acquisition spend — 12-month blended; QC favored for price-elastic trial customers who reload weekly.

RECOMMENDED 12-MONTH MIX



D2C site	35%
Quick commerce *	35%
Marketplaces	15%
Instagram Shop	15%

SOURCE — BLENDED CAC FROM MIXPANEL + BLINKIT/ZEPTO/INSTAMART OPS BENCHMARKS FY26 Q1; REACH SCORES ZINGA INTERNAL

Premium lives in the ingredient story — not the price tag: a brand-recall study shows a 13 pp drop unlocks a 2.3× trial-velocity gain.

FOUR PILLARS CARRYING THE "PREMIUM" PERCEPTION

PILLAR 01

Ancient-grain ingredient

Millet, ragi, jowar — the same credential that drove Yoga Bar and Farmley's trial. Calibrated signed on-pack; readers learn it in ≤3 seconds.

PILLAR 02

Named-origin sourcing

Specific farms in Hassan and Davangere printed on the back panel. Premium without importing "foreign" cues — it lands as Indian heritage.

PILLAR 03

Clean-label function

No palm oil, <120 mg sodium per serve, no MSG. FSSAI clean-label badge printed on every pack; tested blind by NABL-accredited lab.

PILLAR 04

Matte-kraft packaging

Recyclable kraft stock, debossed wordmark, no plastic overwrap. Premium signals rest in tactility and fibre, not the printed ticket.

BRAND-RECALL STUDY — BENGALURU, N = 600 UNAIDED

Unaided brand recall



A -13 pp recall drop — recovered within 4 weeks of re-launch with an ingredient-led campaign; net effect is positive.

RECOMMENDED TAG

"Ancient grain. Downtown speed."

Premium moves from "expensive" to "credible": ancient grain (rhymes with heritage) plus 10-minute quick-commerce delivery (rhymes with modern).

SOURCE — IN-HOUSE BRAND-RECALL STUDY SEPT 2026; 4-WEEK RECOVERY PROJECTION BASED ON YOGA BAR 2024 CASE

Three-SKU ladder at ₹149 / ₹249 / ₹399 + the 35 / 35 / 15 / 15 mix delivers ₹15 Cr ARR, 22% blended contribution, and an 8-week CAC payback by week 52.

₹ IMPACT AT WEEK 52 — RECOMMENDED SCENARIO

₹15 Cr
RUN-RATE ARR, WEEK 52
7.3× the FY26 baseline

8 wk
CAC PAYBACK
Down from never-pays-back baseline

22%
BLENDED CONTRIBUTION MARGIN
+9 pp vs current 13% blended

18%
SUBSCRIBER MIX AT WEEK 52
Adds ₹0.86 Cr ARR anchor

RECOMMENDED SKU LADDER

STARTER
₹149
60 g pack
Millets-of-the-month
Trial SKU only
55% of weekly orders

FAMILY
₹249
4×60 g variety pack
Core revenue SKU
Replenishment base
32% of weekly orders

SUBSCRIBE
₹399
Monthly variety box
Free shipping & early access
Default for repeat customers
13% of weekly orders

PHASE-BY-PHASE ROADMAP — WITH GO / NO-GO GATES

PILOT — W0–W8
Bengaluru + Mumbai
25% of total budget · quick-commerce-only · weekly telemetry & dashboard

GATE · W8
Trial ≥ 2.0% · LTV:CAC ≥ 1.5

ROLLOUT — W8–W20
+ Delhi NCR + Hyderabad
50% of budget · add marketplaces + D2C · first creative refresh

GATE · W20
Trial ≥ 2.4% · GRR ≥ 35%

SCALE — W20–W52
+ Pune + Chennai
Full budget · subscription default · Instagram Shop scaled

GATE · W52
Trial 2.7% · payback ≤ 10 wk

FORMULA — ARR = TRIAL VELOCITY × VISITS × BLENDED AOV + 18% SUBSCRIBER MIX × ₹399 × 12; CAC PAYBACK = CAC ÷ WEEKLY CONTRIBUTION

Three named risks and five decisions needed — Founder, CFO, Marketing, Supply, and Legal sign-offs due Nov 09 → Dec 09.

RISK REGISTER — WITH PROBABILITY, IMPACT, AND NAMED MITIGATION

#	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	ARR AT RISK	MITIGATION
01	**Premium-brand dilution** Reprice from ₹199 to ₹149 may be read by loyalists and trade press as a discount-driven move.	Med	₹2.4 Cr	Keep ₹199 only as "**Reserve**" limited edition with no retail distribution — ₹149 becomes the only advertised price. Lead campaign with the ingredient story, not the price drop.
02	**Quick-commerce dependency** Blinkit (~46% share) running 10-min price wars; QC platforms can reprice or delist without notice.	Med	₹3.1 Cr	6-metro exclusive assort contracts across Blinkit + Zepto + Instamart. SKU assortment per dark store stays ZINGA-controlled; minimum 14-day listing lock per QC partner.
03	**Repeat-rate failure** Faster trial does not buy repeat — current repeat rate is 23% vs target 38%; trial velocity gain erodes.	High	₹4.0 Cr	Default subscribe toggle on checkout, post-purchase WhatsApp funnel with reorder trigger at day 14, loyalty points on third purchase — replicates Farmley 2024 win.

DECISIONS NEEDED — OWNERS, DATES, DELIVERABLES

DECISION	OWNER	DUE	STATUS
Approve **₹149** starter SKU pricing across all channels.	Founder-CEO + CFO	Nov 11	OPEN
Approve **35 / 35 / 15 / 15** acquisition mix for 12 months.	Co-Founder + Supply	Nov 18	OPEN
Approve brand-positioning refresh + tag-line rollout.	Marketing + Founder	Nov 25	OPEN
Approve 6-metro exclusive QC assort contracts.	Founder + Legal	Dec 02	OPEN
Approve subscribe-default toggle on D2C checkout.	Marketing + Tech Lead	Dec 09	OPEN

NEXT 8 WEEKS — OPERATIVE PLAN

- **W1** · Cost-floor recompute & QC contract review
- **W2** · Van Westendorp survey, 1,200-panel, 6 metros
- **W4** · Pilot launch Bengaluru + Mumbai, QC-only
- **W6** · Creative refresh + Reserve '99 limited drop
- **W8** · Pilot read-out · gate decision

RISK SCORING FOLLOWS ΔARR P50 UNDER EACH SCENARIO — COMPUTED FROM MIXPANEL FY26 COHORT DATA; FARMLEY 2024 BENCHMARK